

By Kaveree Bamzai and Sharda Ugra

It's a heady cocktail of sports, entertainment and business and no matter how much India imbibes, it refuses to get a hangover. The third year of the Indian Premier League (IPL) saw the arrival of two new teams, Pune and Kochi, for a combined \$700 million, almost seven times what Mukesh Ambani paid for the Mumbai Indians in 2008. Sahara India and a hastily-assembled conglomerate of Anchor Switches, a diamond businessman, two builders and a ship-breaking sultan are only the latest in a long line of businessmen, actors and men married to or dating actors who arrived at the same realisation.

That 45 days of being flashed onscreen almost as often as cricketers makes up for run-ins with local cricket authorities, careful handling of sensitive sporting stars, nail-biting finishes and yes, the ever-more creative revenue-raising ways of the ringmaster/conductor/head croupier, IPL Chairman Lalit Modi.



BILLION DO

A brand value that has more than doubled to \$4.13 billion and two new teams that cost about as much as the eight of 2008. The IPL now rivals top corporate houses.

IPL is now



SHILPA SHETTY



RAJASTHAN ROYALS

Valuation **\$45.2 mn**

Owners: Emerging Media, (Lachlan Murdoch, Aditya S. Chellaram, Suresh Chellaram, Shilpa Shetty and Raj Kundra)

*Cost of team: **\$67 mn**



SHAH RUKH KHAN



KOLKATA KNIGHT RIDERS

Valuation **\$46 mn**

Owners: Knight Riders Sports, (Shah Rukh Khan, Juhi Chawla, Jai Mehta)

Cost of team: **\$75.09mn**



G.M. RAO



DELHI DAREDEVILS

Valuation **\$40.5 mn**

Owners: GMR Sports Private Ltd

Cost of team: **\$84 mn**



PREITY ZINTA



KINGS XI PUNJAB

Valuation **\$36.1 mn**

Owners: Preity Zinta, Ness Wadia, Mohit Burman, Karan Paul

Cost of team: **\$76 mn**



VIJAY MALLYA



ROYAL CHALLENGERS BANGALORE

Valuation **\$41.9 mn**

Owners: UB Group

Cost of team: **\$111.6 mn**

*Cost of team for a 10-year-period